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FROM FOREIGN OFFICE TO SAN FRANCISCO

(United Kingdom Delegation to the Japanese Peace Treaty Conference)

No. 15
5th September, 1951. D. 7.10 p.m. 5th September, 1951.

IMMEDIATE
SECRET

Addressed to San Francisco (U.K. Del to Japanese Peace Treaty Conference) telegram No. 15 of the 5th September.
Repeated for information to Tokyo,
Tamsui,
and Saving to Washington No. 4556.

Your telegram No. 3 [2nd September].

Japanese Peace Treaty: The Chinese Nationalists.

Mr. Dulles's denial in regard to formal Treaty with Chinese Nationalists is satisfactory.

2. It seems likely, however, particularly in view of paragraph 3 of your telegram under reference, that we may be faced with a proposal for a "practical arrangement" between Japan and the Nationalist authorities after the signature of the Treaty and before its ratification.

3. We should be against any such proposal because:

(a) we would regard it as inconsistent with the agreement reached with Mr. Dulles here in June. As you will remember, the statement then agreed laid down that "Japan's future attitude towards China must necessarily be for determination by Japan itself in the exercise of the sovereign and independent status contemplated by the Treaty". Japan will not attain such status until the Treaty comes into force.

(b) We have always felt that it would be a great mistake for Japan to take any action, before the Treaty comes into force, which could have the effect of prejudicing her highly important economic

/relations

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SECRET

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relations with the mainland of China, since this would give Japanese nationalists in the future a pretext for saying that such action, with its attendant consequences, had been forced upon Japan when she was not yet a free agent.

4. I therefore consider that Japan should make no arrangement, however informal, with the Nationalists until the Treaty comes into force.

5. Unless you see strong objection, please convey this view to Mr. Dulles as soon as possible. Once the Treaty has been signed, we will lose much of the usefulness which we have had for the Americans as joint sponsors, and we must therefore be prepared for a marked decrease in the special consideration which they have given to our views about Japan during the last few months. I consider that we should convey our views to the United States Government on this matter, which has great importance from the point of view of public opinion in the United Kingdom, while they are still fully conscious of their dependence on our support.

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